

Brompton Folding Bicycle, 1981



Folded-up bicycle

Folding bicycle

- **What?** Graziella
- **Who?** Rinaldo Donzelli
- **Where and when?** Italy, 1964

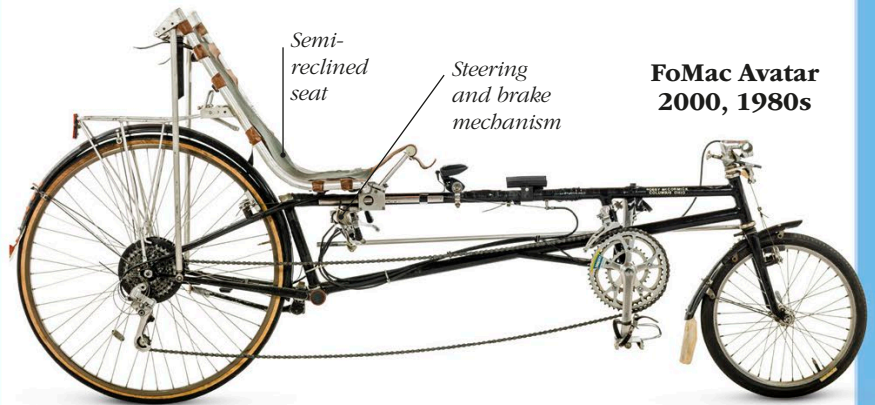
People have been making folding bicycles for as long as there have been bicycles. Although the first fold-up design dates back to the 1860s, it was the Graziella that made these bicycles popular. In 1976, the British Brompton Folding Bicycle hit the road and became world-famous. Light and speedy, it could be folded in less than 20 seconds to make a compact package.

Modern recumbent bicycle

- **What?** Avatar 2000
- **Who?** David Gordon Wilson
- **Where and when?** US, early 1980s

On “recumbent” (reclining) bicycles, the rider lies back, with the pedals out in front. This is not only

comfortable, but it cuts down the body area presented to the wind, so is great for speed records, although the restricted view makes it less practical for city use.



FoMac Avatar 2000, 1980s

Mountain bicycle

- **What?** Specialized Stumpjumper
- **Who?** Tom Ritchey, Gary Fisher, Charles Kelly
- **Where and when?** US, 1981

BMX bicycles were thought of mainly as bicycles for kids. Then, in 1981, the “Stumpjumper” was introduced. This was the first mountain bicycle. Today, mountain bikes are hugely popular with all ages—not just for those who want to ride off-road, but also those who want a rugged bicycle for bumpy city streets.

Raised knobs, or “lugs,” on the wheels provide a firm grip on rough terrain.

Strong, compact frame

Short, straight handlebars for easy handling

FAST FACTS

- In 1986, Kestrel made the first streamlined bicycle frame from carbon composites.
- In 2013, Shimano introduced an electronic system for changing the gears almost instantly.
- In 2016–2017, the American cyclist Amanda Coker cycled 100,000 miles (160,930 km) in just 423 days, averaging more than 236 miles (380 km) a day.